Rules

This is a detective game played entirely inside this PDF. Click the blue buttons to make your choices and move between pages.

Your inventory is shown at the top of every page. Some choices are greyed out until you are carrying the right item.

Page numbers are shuffled, so flipping ahead will not help you. Use the buttons, not the scroll bar.

Start game

Start

It is 3 a.m. Your phone buzzes on the nightstand: an alert from your homelab. Something is very wrong.

Open the dashboard

Everything goes black

The monitors click off. The server chassis fans wind down to complete silence. Total darkness fills the room.

Hit the physical power button to restart

Wait in the dark

Remove Internet connection

You rip the ethernet cable out of the router. The blinking lights go quiet. But the attack was already writing to your disks when the link dropped.

Check the damage

Still attacking

The attack never stopped. Whoever is behind it is still hammering your lab, and the router is wide open again.

Close all open ports on the router

Kernel deleted

You open the console. The kernel has been deleted. The machine is still running from memory, but it will not survive a reboot. You need to get it back, and fast.

Ask an AI how to recover the kernel

Ask Reddit how to recover the kernel

Restart

The BIOS splash screen appears. Services begin initializing one by one as the OS boots back up from disk.

Check the container status

Everything goes black

The monitors click off. The server chassis fans wind down to complete silence. Total darkness fills the room.

Hit the physical power button to restart

Wait in the dark

No internet

Silence. Without a connection you cannot look up fixes, ask for help or download anything. You are alone with the damage.

Plug the ethernet cable back in

Plug back ethernet

The link light turns green again. For a few seconds everything looks fine. Then the traffic graph spikes.

Check the graphs

Everything goes black

The monitors click off. The server chassis fans wind down to complete silence. Total darkness fills the room.

Hit the physical power button to restart

Wait in the dark

20% data loss

A fifth of your files are gone or corrupted. The rest of the lab is cut off from the world.

Stay offline and think

Plug the ethernet cable back in

Something happened

The terminal flashes a cascade of cryptic messages. The screen freezes for a moment. You aren't entirely sure what just executed, but the system state has fundamentally shifted.

Try to revert using the AI method

Wait for the system response

Ask an AI

You paste the panic-induced error logs into an AI chatbot. It confidently outputs a multi-step kernel compilation and reinstallation command string. You copy-paste and execute it.

See what happens

Containers offline

SSH access is restored, and the base OS is healthy. However, Docker is completely empty—all your containers, databases, and media servers failed to start up automatically.

Homelab DDoS

Traffic graphs are through the roof. Thousands of requests per second are hammering your homelab. The router fans are screaming. You have to act now.

Remove the Internet connection

Close all open ports on the router

Ask an AI

You paste the panic-induced error logs into an AI chatbot. It confidently outputs a multi-step kernel compilation and reinstallation command string. You copy-paste and execute it.

See what happens

Kernel deleted

You open the console. The kernel has been deleted. The machine is still running from memory, but it will not survive a reboot. You need to get it back, and fast.

Ask an AI how to recover the kernel

Ask Reddit how to recover the kernel

Ask Reddit

You post on r/homelab with the title: 'PLEASE HELP MY KERNEL IS DELETED

Execute the Reddit advice

20% data loss

The ports are closed, but the attacker was already inside. A fifth of your files are gone or corrupted, and the system is acting strangely.

Look at the system more closely

Kernel deleted

You open the console. The kernel has been deleted. The machine is still running from memory, but it will not survive a reboot. You need to get it back, and fast.

Ask an AI how to recover the kernel

Ask Reddit how to recover the kernel

Close all open ports on router

You log into the router and shut every forwarded port: SSH, HTTPS, the Jellyfin stream, everything. The router is quiet for a moment, then the logs start scrolling again.

Check the damage

Check the server console

Ask Reddit

You post on r/homelab with the title: 'PLEASE HELP MY KERNEL IS DELETED

Execute the Reddit advice

Something happened

The terminal flashes a cascade of cryptic messages. The screen freezes for a moment. You aren't entirely sure what just executed, but the system state has fundamentally shifted.

Try to revert using the AI method (locked)

Wait for the system response

Something happened

The terminal flashes a cascade of cryptic messages. The screen freezes for a moment. You aren't entirely sure what just executed, but the system state has fundamentally shifted.

Try to revert using the AI method

Wait for the system response (locked)